

COURSEWORK SPECIFICATIONS

Learning Institute for Empowerment
Coursework Specifications: Mapping CLOs to Coursework Assessments
Trimester: MARCH/ APRIL 2026 (T2610)

Subject Code & Name: LAE1113 ACADEMIC ENGLISH
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Assessment breakdown: 50% Coursework, 50% Final Exam

CLO	Description	Domain	Level	Assessment Component		
				Assignment (30%)	Presentation (20%)	Final Exam (50%)
1	Demonstrate the ability to produce effective synthesis essay.	Cognitive	3	✓		
2	Interpret texts critically by using relevant reading skills	Cognitive	3			✓
3	Apply rules of grammar correctly in different settings	Cognitive	3			✓
4	Present opinions on various issues	Affective	2		✓	

ASSIGNMENT: ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY (30%)

CLO1: Demonstrate the ability to produce an effective synthesis essay

Description: The task is to produce an academic essay (argumentative in nature) supported with relevant reading materials of a chosen topic. The project introduces students to academic research through means of reading and synthesising ideas from relevant sources or literature. They will learn to locate, use and organise their information and data to execute the task. Writing skills such as paraphrasing, summarising, citing, synthesising, organising, writing and editing will be incorporated as they complete the essay.

Objectives:

At the end of the task, students should be able to:

- locate, use, and organise information and data
- extract ideas from relevant sources, cite, draft, and revise

General guidelines:

1. Students will work in groups of **3 – 4 people**.
2. A chosen topic needs to be narrowed down. For example:
Topic: Capital punishment
*Thesis: Capital punishment **should not** be implemented because of several reasons.*
*Thesis statement: Capital punishment **should not** be implemented **because it is against moral values, it does not act as a deterrent, and it may claim innocent lives.***
3. Students must select **three (3) to five (5) articles** (articles from published sources like journals, books, magazines, newspapers and others) which are published from **2020 to 2025**.
4. Students need to synthesise and paraphrase information from the articles to support their thesis. **Each body paragraph must include 1-2 citations, formatted in APA style.** Citations should primarily appear in the body paragraphs where evidence is discussed. While citations are not typically required in the introduction and conclusion, if students choose to include them, they should ensure that they are used appropriately and contribute meaningfully to the overall argument.
5. Selection of argumentative topics will be shared with students to choose from. Students **can submit their outline to the lecturer** in Week 7.
6. Students are encouraged to submit an outline by **Week 7** for checking purposes, but the submissions carry **NO MARKS**.
7. The essay length is **3-4 pages**; excluding the title, reference and other pages. All pages must be **justified and numbered**.
8. The font is **Times New Roman, size 12, and double spacing**.
9. The front page should include the name of the University, the title of the Essay, student's name, ID no. and section no., and the name of the lecturer.
10. A template of the front page and the page for the essay will be put up online as reference. Students should adhere to the specifications given.
11. The essay will go through submission for plagiarism similarity index and AI-generated content. Please refer to **Plagiarism and AI-Generated Content Submission Guidelines**.
12. The submission deadline is **Week 9**.

Order of pages: (Ensure that you start on a fresh page for each part)

- Cover page
- Outline
- Academic Essay
- References

Recommended Flow Chart:

1. Writing project issued.
2. Students start searching for the topic provided by reading up outside of class time.
3. Select a topic and narrow it down.
4. Obtain lecturer's approval on the topic and articles chosen.
5. Record information, organise and interpret data. Outline submission.
6. Synthesise and paraphrase.
7. Start writing the essay.
8. Quote and document sources.
9. Submit for plagiarism similarity index & AI-generated Content
10. Final submission in **Week 9**

Plagiarism and AI-Generated Content Submission Guidelines

Students are required to submit reports on plagiarism similarity index and AI-generated content alongside their essays.

Please ensure the following:

1. Plagiarism Similarity Index
The similarity index must not exceed 20%.
2. AI-generated Content
The AI-generated content within the essay must be lower than 20%.

Note:

1. Both the reports must be generated through the Turnitin plagiarism detection tool.
2. If an essay does not comply with the limits set for plagiarism similarity index or AI-generated content in the first submission, students must revise their essay and resubmit the report(s). Lecturers may allow students up to 5 days to resubmit their report(s) and essay.
3. Failure to fulfil the limits set for plagiarism similarity index and AI-generated content will result in the essay being awarded a score not exceeding 50% of the total score. For instance, if the total score is 30 marks, an essay which fails to fulfil the limits set will be awarded a score not exceeding 15 marks.
4. Without the reports, the submission is deemed incomplete. If the reports are still not submitted after students are reminded of doing so, the examiner will proceed to grade the essay, and students will not be allowed to revise and resubmit the essay in a case where the limits set for plagiarism similarity index and AI-generated content are not complied with.

Argumentative Essay Rubric (30%)

Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0-1 mark	2 marks	3 marks	4 marks	5 marks
Introduction and Conclusion (5 marks)	Presents a poor or weak introduction with no thesis statement or an unclear thesis statement Provides no conclusion or an illogical conclusion	Presents a partially clear introduction with a partially clear thesis statement Provides a logical but underdeveloped conclusion	Presents a clear introduction with a sufficiently stated thesis statement Provides a logical and adequate conclusion	Presents a well-focused introduction with a specific and clear thesis statement Provides a logical and well-developed conclusion	Presents a highly engaging and well-crafted introduction with a precise, insightful thesis statement Provides a logical, insightful, and impactful conclusion
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0 - 2 marks	3 - 4 marks	5 - 6 marks	7 - 8 marks	9 - 10 marks
Body Paragraphs (10 marks)	Presents limited or poorly developed arguments that may be irrelevant or repetitive, with no topic sentences. Presents limited to no synthesising of source content, dealing with a single issue only, with little to no paraphrasing. Includes an unclear or missing concession and refutation.	Presents partially developed arguments that may be unclear, repetitive, or inaccurate, with missing or unclear topic sentences. Presents minimal synthesising of content from a few sources focused on a single issue, with minimal paraphrasing. Includes a weak concession and refutation.	Presents adequately developed arguments with partially clear topic sentences. Presents some synthesising of content from some sources focused on a single issue, with some appropriate paraphrasing. Includes a basic concession and refutation.	Presents clearly developed arguments with sufficiently clear topic sentences. Presents effective synthesising of content from several sources focused on a single issue, with mostly accurate and appropriate paraphrasing. Includes a clear concession and refutation.	Presents fully developed, coherent, and well-supported arguments with specific and clear topic sentences. Presents clear and effective synthesising of content from several sources focused on a single issue, with accurate and fluent paraphrasing. Includes a well-crafted concession and refutation.
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0-1 mark	2 marks	3 marks	4 marks	5 marks
Organisation (5 marks)	Presents information and ideas with limited or no logical	Presents information and ideas with some sequencing and	Presents information and ideas with clear and logical sequencing.	Presents information and ideas with logical and effective	Presents information and ideas with excellent and seamless

	sequencing. Presents few or inaccurate cohesive devices. Presents inappropriate or missing paragraphing.	basic coherence. Presents basic cohesive devices, though some may be inaccurate. Presents paragraphing with noticeable issues.	Presents cohesive devices effectively, though some use may be mechanical. Presents appropriate paragraphing.	sequencing. Presents cohesive devices accurately and consistently. Presents skilful paragraphing.	sequencing. Presents cohesive devices naturally and precisely. Presents strategic and impactful paragraphing.
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor 0-1 mark	Poor 2 marks	Average 3 marks	Good 4 marks	Excellent 5 marks
Citations and References (5 marks)	Presents missing or inaccurate in-text citations. Presents no consistent attempt to include 1–2 citations per body paragraph. Presents missing or poorly formatted reference list.	Presents some citations, but with frequent APA formatting errors Presents fewer than 1 citation per body paragraph on average. Presents an incomplete or inaccurate reference list.	Presents generally accurate in-text citations, with minor APA errors. Presents 1 citation in most body paragraphs. Presents a mostly accurate reference list.	Presents accurate in-text citations, mostly in the correct APA format. Presents 1–2 citations in each body paragraph. Presents a complete and mostly correct reference list.	Presents consistently accurate in-text citations in APA format. Presents 1–2 well-integrated citations in each body paragraph that clearly support the argument. Presents a fully accurate and properly formatted APA reference list..
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor 1 mark	Poor 2 marks	Average 3 marks	Good 4 marks	Excellent 5 marks
Language and Vocabulary (5 marks)	Presents severe grammatical errors that make the essay difficult or impossible to understand. Presents inappropriate and frequently inaccurate vocabulary that hinders meaning.	Presents frequent grammatical errors that disrupt the flow of the essay. Presents limited or inappropriate vocabulary that affects clarity.	Presents noticeable grammatical errors, though meaning remains clear. Presents adequate vocabulary, with some incorrect or repetitive word choices.	Presents mostly accurate grammar with few minor errors that do not affect understanding. Presents good vocabulary and word choice, with occasional errors in usage.	Presents accurate grammar throughout with correct punctuation, capitalisation, and spelling. Presents precise and sophisticated vocabulary that enhances clarity and strengthens the argument.

PRESENTATION (20%)

CLO4: *Present opinions on various issues*

Objective: To assess the students' abilities to present opinions effectively.

General guidelines:

1. The same members from the writing assignment are retained for the presentation.
 2. The lecturers will provide the argumentative topics by **week 6**. Each group will have approximately **15 minutes** to present.
 3. Students are to choose a stance on the topic. Members of the same group may have differing opinions and can choose to either agree or disagree.
 4. Each team member will be **assessed individually** for the presentation.
 5. Dress code: formal.
 6. Presentation mode: Face-to-face presentation in **Week 10**.
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Scoring Rubrics for Oral Presentation [20 Marks]

Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0-1 mark	2 marks	3 marks	4 marks	5 marks
Content and Organisation (5 marks)	Minimal understanding: ideas are underdeveloped or off-topic. No evidence of understanding or relevant content.	Limited understanding; vague or poorly organised content.	Adequate understanding: some relevant points but may lack clarity or structure.	Good understanding and clear organisation; ideas are generally relevant and well explained.	Demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic; content is highly relevant, insightful, and well-structured with a clear line of reasoning.
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0 - 2 marks	2 marks	3 marks	4 marks	5 marks
Fluency and Coherence (5 marks)	Frequently incoherent; very difficult to follow. Speech is largely unintelligible.	Hesitant or repetitive speech; difficult to follow at times.	Noticeable pauses; ideas occasionally disorganised.	Mostly fluent with minor hesitations; ideas are generally coherent.	Highly fluent and confident delivery; ideas are logically sequenced and connected seamlessly.
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0-1 mark	2 marks	3 marks	4 marks	5 marks
Language Use (Vocabulary & Grammar) (5 marks)	Very limited vocabulary and grammar; meaning often unclear. Vocabulary and grammar impede communication entirely.	Frequent vocabulary or grammar errors that occasionally hinder meaning.	Basic vocabulary and limited grammar range; some noticeable errors.	Appropriate vocabulary and mostly accurate grammar with some variety.	Wide range of accurate vocabulary and grammatical structures used effectively.
Criteria/ Marks	Very Poor	Poor	Average	Good	Excellent
	0-1 mark	2 marks	3 marks	4 marks	5 marks
Pronunciation and Delivery (Clarity, Intonation, Body Language) (5 marks)	Difficult to understand and minimal use of non-verbal cues. Unclear and disengaged throughout.	Often unclear; weak projection and limited non-verbal engagement.	Generally understandable but delivery lacks confidence or variation.	Mostly clear and well-paced; minor lapses in delivery or engagement.	Clear and confident pronunciation, effective intonation and pacing; excellent use of body language and eye contact.

READING PROJECT (30%)

CLO2: Interpret texts critically by using relevant reading skills

Objective: At the end of the task, students should be able to analyse critically a reading article using relevant reading skills.

General guidelines:

1. This is an individual reading project.
2. Each student will get two reading articles and two sets of questions.
3. The article and the questions will be given to the students in **Week 12 (15 – 21 June 2026)** during lecture hour.
4. Students are given **1.5hours (90 minutes)** to answer all questions and submit the answers.
5. **Individually, the students need to answer all given questions in written form.**
6. The answers will need to be written on the template provided together with the question paper.

GRAMMAR QUIZ (20%)

CLO 3: Apply rules of grammar correctly in different settings

Objective: At the end of the task, students should be able to use the relevant grammar correctly in different settings

General guidelines:

1. This is an individual assessment.
2. Students will do a grammar quiz that tests questions on **Modal Verbs** and **Faulty Modifiers**.
3. The quiz will be done physically in class.
4. Only **one (1)** attempt is possible.
5. The quiz will be carried out in **Week 14 (29 June – 5 July 2026)** during lecture hour.
6. Students are given **1 hour (60minutes)** to complete it.

